



VICTIM SERVICES BRANCH FEDERAL FUND INFORMATION GUIDE

This document contains information about the common Victim Services Branch (VSB) federal fund sources. Applicants are strongly encouraged to review this document to familiarize themselves with the requirements for all fund sources that support the program they apply for.

Federal fund information for funds not listed in this guide can be found in the applicable Program Supplemental.

I. Victims of Crime Act Victim Assistance Formula Grant Program

The Program is authorized by the Victims of Crime Act of 1984 (34 U.S.C. § 20103 (a) and (b)).

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to support eligible crime victim assistance programs that: 1) respond to the emotional and physical needs of victims of crime; 2) help primary and secondary victims of crime to stabilize their lives after a victimization; 3) help victims of crime understand and participate in the criminal justice system; and 4) provide victims of crime with a measure of safety and security. Crime victim is defined as any person who has suffered physical, sexual, financial, or emotional harm as a result of the commission of a crime.

B. Match

The Program requires a cash and/or in-kind match equal to 20 percent of the total project cost. Match is calculated using the total project cost method. Federally recognized American Indian or Alaska Native tribes/organizations located on tribal land are exempt from match.

Full and partial waivers may be requested.

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Subrecipients must:

- Use funds to provide direct services to victims of crime

- Have a record of effective direct service to victims of crime
- Utilize volunteers unless there is a compelling reason to waive this requirement
- Not deny services to victims based on immigration status
- Not charge victims for services provided by Grant Subaward funds

Unallowable costs include, but are not limited to:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research
- Criminal defense
- Investigation/Prosecution

The following costs are allowable only as part of an indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services
- Legal services for agency (legal assistance for victims is allowable)
- Supervision of non-direct service staff
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 16.575.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is VOCA.

II. Services, Training, Officers, and Prosecutors Violence Against Women Formula Grant Program

The Program was authorized in 1994 through the Violence Against Women Act (VAWA). VAWA, Public Law 103-322 was reauthorized in 2000, 2005, 2013, and most recently in 2022. The Program is administered by the Office on Violence Against Women, U.S. Department of Justice.

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to promote the development and implementation of effective, victim-centered law enforcement,

prosecution, and court strategies to address violent crimes against women and the development and enhancement of victim services in cases involving violent crimes against women. States and communities are encouraged to restructure and strengthen the criminal justice system response to domestic violence, sexual assault, and stalking, drawing upon the experience of all participants in the system.

B. Match

The Program requires a cash or in-kind match equal to 25 percent of the total project cost. Match is calculated using the total project cost method. Tribes and victim service providers are exempt from this requirement and cannot be required to provide matching funds.

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Unallowable costs include, but are not limited to:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research
- Vehicle purchase (leasing is allowable)

The following costs are allowable only as part of indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services
- Legal services for agency (direct services to victims is allowable)
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 16.588.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is STOP.

III. The Family Violence Prevention and Services/Domestic Violence Shelter and Supportive Services/Awards to States

The Program is authorized by 42 U.S.C. § 10401, Family Violence Prevention and Services Act.

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to assist states in their efforts to support the establishment, maintenance, and expansion of programs and project to: 1) prevent incidents of family violence, domestic violence, and dating violence; 2) provide immediate shelter, supportive services, and access to community-based programs for victims of family violence, domestic violence, or dating violence, and their dependents; and 3) provide specialized services for children exposed to family violence, domestic violence, or dating violence including victims who are members of underserved populations.

B. Match

The Program requires a cash or in-kind match of no less than 20 percent. Indian Tribe/Tribes/Native American Tribe (any Indian Tribe, band, nation, or other organized group or community, including any Alaska Native village or regional or village corporation as defined in or established pursuant to the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act) are exempt from match.

No other exemptions or waivers are allowed.

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Subrecipients must:

- Not consider a victim's income when determining eligibility for services
- Not require victims to participate in services as a condition of shelter eligibility

Funds may not be used for:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research
- Direct payment to victims

The following costs are allowable only as part of indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services
- Legal services for agency (direct services to victims is allowable)
- Supervision of non-direct service staff
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 93.671.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is FVPS.

E. Americans with Disabilities Act Information and Trainings

Subrecipients should review the following links:

- [Americans with Disabilities Act Website](#)
- [A Guide to Disability Rights Law Website](#)
- [ADA Primer for States and Local Governments Website](#)
- [ADA Accessibility Standards Website](#)

Subrecipients may refer to the following link for supplemental ADA webinars:

- [Upcoming Webinars & Training Link](#)

IV. Children's Justice Act Grants to States

The Program is authorized by Section 107(a-f) of the Child Abuse Prevention and Treatment Act (42 U.S.C. 5106c et seq.) as amended by Public Law (P.L.) 111-320 enacted December 20, 2010; and the Victims of Crime Act of 1984, as amended (42 U.S.C. 10603 et seq.).

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to assist states in developing, establishing, and operating programs designed to improve: 1) the assessment and investigation of suspected child abuse and neglect cases, including cases of suspected child sexual abuse and exploitation, in a manner that limits additional trauma to the child and the child's family; 2) the assessment and investigation of cases of suspected child abuse-related fatalities and suspected child neglect-related fatalities; 3) the investigation and prosecution of cases of child

abuse and neglect, including child sexual abuse and exploitation; and
4) the assessment and investigation of cases involving children with disabilities or serious health-related problems who are suspected victims of child abuse or neglect.

B. Match

There is no match requirement.

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Funds may not be used for:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research

The following costs are allowable only as part of indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services
- Legal services for agency – direct services to victims is allowable)
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 93.643.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is CJA0.

V. Sexual Assault Services Formula Program

The Program is authorized by 34 U.S.C. §12511. The Program was created by the Violence Against Women and Department of Justice Reauthorization Act of 2005, as amended by the technical amendments to that act, and is the first federal funding stream solely dedicated to the provision of direct intervention and related assistance for victims of sexual assault.

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to support rape crisis centers and other nonprofit, nongovernmental organizations or tribal programs that provide direct intervention and related assistance to victims of sexual assault, without regard to age.

B. Match

There is no match requirement

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Funds may not be used for:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research
- Vehicles purchase (leasing is allowable)
- Prevention efforts and education (e.g., bystander intervention, social norms campaigns, presentations on healthy relationships, etc.)
- Criminal justice-related projects, including law enforcement, prosecution, courts, and forensic interviews
- Sexual Assault Forensic Medical Examinations
- Sexual Assault Response Team coordination
- Training to allied professions and the community (e.g., law enforcement, child protection services, prosecution, other community-based organizations, etc.).
- Domestic violence services unrelated to sexual violence

The following costs are allowable only as part of indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services
- Legal services for agency – direct services to victims is allowable)
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 16.017.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is SASP.

VI. Paul Coverdell Forensic Science Improvement Grants Program

The Program is authorized by Public Law 90-351, Title I, Sec. 2801-2806 (codified at 34 U.S.C. 10561-10566).

A. Purpose

The purpose of the Program is to provide funding to acquire and maintain accreditation; to improve the quality and timeliness of forensic services; to eliminate a backlog in the analysis of forensic science evidence; to train, assist and employ forensic laboratory personnel and medicolegal death investigators, as needed to eliminate such a backlog; to address emerging forensic science issues; to educate and train forensic pathologists; and to fund medicolegal death investigation systems to facilitate accreditation of medical examiner and coroner offices and certification of medicolegal death investigators.

B. Match

There is no match requirement.

C. Restrictions/Guidelines

Funds may not be used for:

- Mortgage payments
- Property tax
- Fundraising
- Lobbying
- Research
- General law enforcement functions or non-forensic investigatory functions
- Purchase and/or lease of vehicles, such as crime scene vans

The following costs are allowable only as part of indirect cost line-item:

- Contracts for bookkeeping or human resources services

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- Legal services for agency
- Building liability insurance
- Human resources staff
- Staff time without Functional Timesheet

D. Codes

- The Assistance Listing Number for the Program is 16.742.
- The Cal OES four-character code for this Program is FSIA.